Brian Gross

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Visual Storytelling Leader

Turning innovative and ambitious graphic design into a competitive advantage for media organizations through strategic planning, cross-functional collaboration and talent development.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Washington Post, Washington D.C. (2010-2026)

Modernized design operations at one of the world's most respected newsrooms during a period of significant growth, aligning teams, processes and priorities. Amplified the defining journalism of the era through premium immersive presentations, positioning the organization as an industry leader.

- Acquired top talent and managed a team of 50+ editors, art directors, developers.
- Led design at scale as newsroom doubled and company returned to profitability.
- Resulted in audience of 75m monthly visitors, 3m subscribers, 7.5m social followers.
- Contributed to 14 Pulitzers and 17 finalists by embedding design at earliest stages.

Director, News Design Department (2024-2026)

- Edited and managed assignments for 200 high-impact presentations, 1,800 social posts and 1,200 illustrations.
- Standardized data collection, tracking and analysis by defining goals at project start.
- Formed a task force to launch reusable tools, resulting in 5.1m views on 104 stories.
- Scaled in-house illustration expertise to reduce reliance on external vendors.
- Drove a newsroom style guide and color palette update, unblocking project delays and aligning stakeholders.
- Accelerated AI adoption by leading advisory groups and driving workflow efficiency.

Deputy Director, News Design Department (2014-2024)

- Established a restrained, content-first identity to be a signal in the noise.
- Transitioned print designers into developers through targeted training, skill sharing.
- Doubled staff to 50 and added managers to meet demand for ambition and quality.
- Introduced dedicated roles for project editing, illustrated reporting, motion graphics and digital infrastructure.
- Collaborated on branding for verticals, podcasts, games and Apple News.
- Built a culture of growth where designers could experiment and pitch ideas.
- Retained and promoted top performers through mentoring and career development.

Senior Designer (2010-2014)

- Took on leadership responsibility while raising the bar for creativity, experimentation.
- Gained fluency in tools and daily creative challenges to advocate for designers.
- Conceived, project managed and edited visual stories of all sizes.

University of Maryland College of Journalism, College Park MD (2026)

Adjunct lecturer teaching graduate-level students to create multimedia storytelling and build responsive websites using wireframes, HTML, CSS and data visualization tools.

EARLY CAREER EXPERIENCE

- **The Boston Globe,** Boston MA: Sports Designer and Team Leader (2002-2010)
- **San Diego Union-Tribune,** San Diego CA: Sports Designer (1999-2002)
- **Savannah Morning News**, Savannah GA: News Designer (1996-1999)
- **Kinston Free-Press**, Kinston NC: Reporter and Designer (1994-1995)
- **Suburban Journals**, Belleville IL: Reporter and Photographer (1994)

AWARDS

Pulitzer Prize (Staff): National Reporting for AR-15 series, 2024; Public Service for January 6 coverage, 2022

Society for News Design: World's Best Digital (2020, 2025); Best in Show (2020, 2024); World's Best Newspaper Finalist (2013-15, 2020, 2022); multiple silver medals and portfolio awards

Society of Publication Designers: Gold Medal (2024)

SERVICE

Society for News Design: Creative Competition Judge (2005, 2016), Digital Competition Chair (2019–2024); Team Captain (2025-2026), Workshop Speaker (2002, 2005, 2015, 2025, 2026)

Poynter Leadership Academy (2006, 2015)

Society of Publication Designers: Coffee + Convo mentor (2025)

Montgomery Soccer Inc: Coach of high school girls recreation team for 15 seasons (2016-2024)

CONSULTING

Digital and print design clients
Philadelphia Inquirer
University of Tampa Journal
Wake Forest Magazine

EDUCATION

Southern Illinois University
Carbondale IL
Bachelor's in Journalism

Dow Jones News Fund: Training at University of Missouri

Columbus Dispatch: Copy Editing Intern

The Daily Egyptian: Editor-in-Chief